

Diploma in

# PHOTOSHOP



## SUMMARY NOTES

Layer Types & Masking  
Lesson 3

THIS LESSON INTRODUCES YOU TO ONE OF THE MOST IMPORTANT FUNCTIONS IN PHOTOSHOP, LAYERS. LAYERS ALLOW YOU TO ENHANCE IMAGES IN A NON-DESTRUCTIVE AND CONTINUOUSLY RE-EDITABLE MANNER. WE LOOK AT THE BASIC PRINCIPLES AND CONCEPTS OF USING LAYERS AND WILL DISCUSS ALL THE DIFFERENT TYPE OF LAYERS PHOTOSHOP OFFERS. WE WILL ALSO DISCUSS MASKS, HOW THEY IMPACT YOUR IMAGE AND THEIR POWER WITHIN THIS EDITING SOFTWARE.

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**3.01** What Are Layers?

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**3.02** Layer Types

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**3.03** Masking

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## LESSON 3

## WHAT ARE LAYERS?

**“Layers are at the very core of image editing in Photoshop. We can think of layers in Photoshop as stackable elements, each of which holds a part of your image and they’re displayed in descending order.”**

Photoshop layers are like sheets of stacked glass. You can see through transparent areas of a layer to the layers below. Transparency is represented by a chequered board pattern. A fully transparent area is missing colour in each square pixel. You can also change the opacity of a layer to make content partially transparent. These pixels are filled with colour but have a low value of transparency. Layers are non-destructive and completely reversible. They allow for safer and more professional editing.

Layers are at the very core of image editing in Photoshop. We can think of layers in Photoshop as stackable elements, each of which holds a part of your image and they’re displayed in descending order. Photoshop first introduced layers in 1994, and they have gotten incredibly complex since them! But the introduction of layers revolutionised photography. We can have up to 8,000 layers in an individual PSD.



## Layers Tab

This refers to the overall lightness or darkness. We will change entire image pixels

## Filter

This will allow use to quickly find layers in bigger projects

## Adjustment Layer

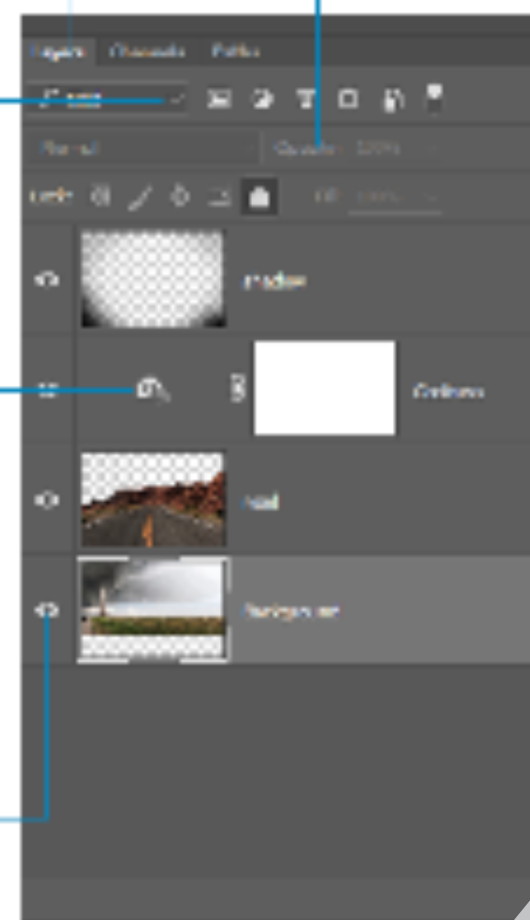
An adjustment layer is a non-destructive Adjustment. It comes

## Toggle

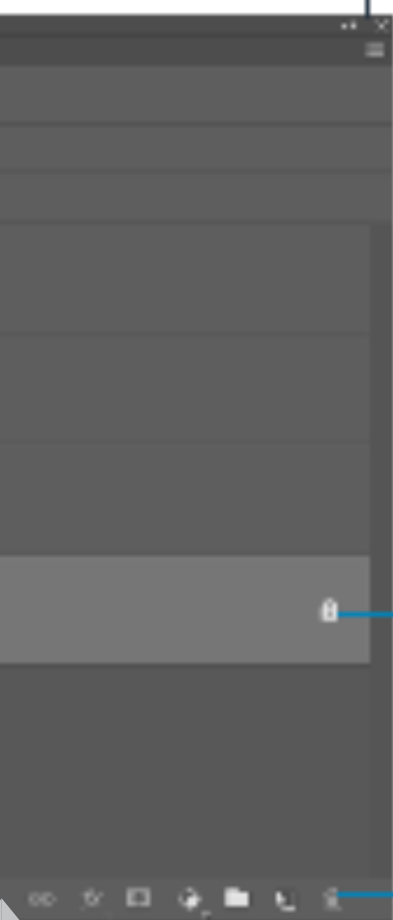
This toggle will allow you to turn of the visibility off or on

## Opacity

This will all you to low visibility level of the l



over the  
layer selected



## Remove/Compact

- This will allow you to remove or hide the layers panel. If you remove the layers panel, you can open it back up using the Window menu

## New Layer

- Another layer, this can be blank or can be filled as another image

## Background

- Most images, when open in Photoshop will default with a locked background layer

## Layer Options

- Here you can delete a layer, create a new layer, create a folder, create an adjustment layer, add a mask, add layer effects or link multiple layers

# LAYER TYPES

## Pixel Layer

The Pixel Layers are at the heart of image editing. A Pixel Layer is basically every image in you take and/or import into Photoshop. Blank Pixel Layers are transparent, meaning if we have a layer below we can see the pixels (the image). Using tools such as Brush and Burn alters the pixels of an image. Using Destructive Adjustments Alters the Pixels of your image

## Adjustment Layer

An adjustment layer applies colour and tonal adjustments to your image without permanently changing pixel values, therefore they are considered non-destructive. The adjustments are stored in the adjustment layer and apply to all the layers below it. There are many advantages to using adjustment layers. As they are non-destructive, you can try different settings and re-edit the adjustment layer at any time. You can also reduce the effect of the adjustment by lowering the opacity of the layer or delete the adjustment entirely. Because adjustment layers contain adjustment data rather than pixels, they increase file size far less than standard pixel layers.

## Text Layer

A text layer works just like a word document. You can change the type of font, the size and the colour. Each use of the text tool will create a new text layer to be edited and moved on the document stage. The text layer can be rasterised into pixels for further editing.

## Shape Layer

A Shape layer is a vector based design within the largely raster based Photoshop. A shape layer is not pixel based but a vector meaning it can scale up and down without any loss to the image. This is like Adobe Illustrator, a vector based editor. The shape layer can be added and subtracted from using the various other shape layer types. The shape layers consist of a rectangle, rounded rectangle, ellipse, polygon and custom shape options based on icons. You can create your own custom shapes and save them in Photoshop for further use.





# MASKING

Masking can be explained as hiding certain pixels to let the image below be seen. Masks are applied to a layer and can be used on every type of layer. Layer masks use values of grey to assign levels of transparency to specific portions of a layer or group of layers. To add the Layer mask use the option on the bottom of the layer as tab. Use the brush tool when you have the layer mask selected.

A good way to remember the values of masking is to say:

**“Black to Conceal, White to Reveal”**

White will show your layer while black will hide or mask the layer.









THANK YOU